UNIT 3: EXPLORING CAREERS

TOPIC 2: CAREER RESEARCH

Topic OBJECTIVES: The learner will:

- Increase his or her understanding of "growing" careers
- Apply their own knowledge, skills, and understanding of their interests and values to choosing careers of interest to explore further

Topic OUTCOMES: The learner will:

- Understand occupational information, including the concept of "supply and demand"
- Have a completed research sheet for their Student Career Portfolio which identifies their careers of interest, along with the necessary occupational and educational requirements for each of the careers

Topic ACTIVITIES:

Large Group Discussion

Objectives:
- Students will explore current occupations that are experiencing growth.
- Students will understand that many factors can influence career demand.

Time: 15 minutes

Materials: Handout: **"Jobs for the Twenty-First Century,"** pens/pencils

Explain to students that besides their own interests and training, other factors go into what jobs they will have available to them. Suggest several labor market trends they may have noticed or heard about (green jobs, working from home, outsourcing, etc.). Hand out **"Jobs for the Twenty-First Century."** Explain that the charts represent two groups of careers that are growing — meaning there are more available openings, as opposed to some other careers. Have students suggest a reason one of the careers in the charts may be growing. Ask students to circle any careers on the handout they may want to learn more about.

Technical (Mass CIS)/Research

Objective: Students will use their personal and career knowledge to select potential careers.

Time: 45 minutes

Materials: Handout: **"Career Research Sheet,"** computers with internet connection, index cards with **Mass CIS** log-in names and passwords, pens/pencils

Have students log-in to **Mass CIS**. Ask them to find three occupations of interest using the **"Occupation Sort"** function or just choose on their own. For each career, ask students to list which career cluster it belongs to, what the average rate of pay is, and what type of training or education is needed. Once completed, students should copy this information on to the **"Career Research Sheet"** handout and add it to their Student Career Portfolio.

Chart 7. Percent change in employment in occupations projected to grow fastest, 2006-2016

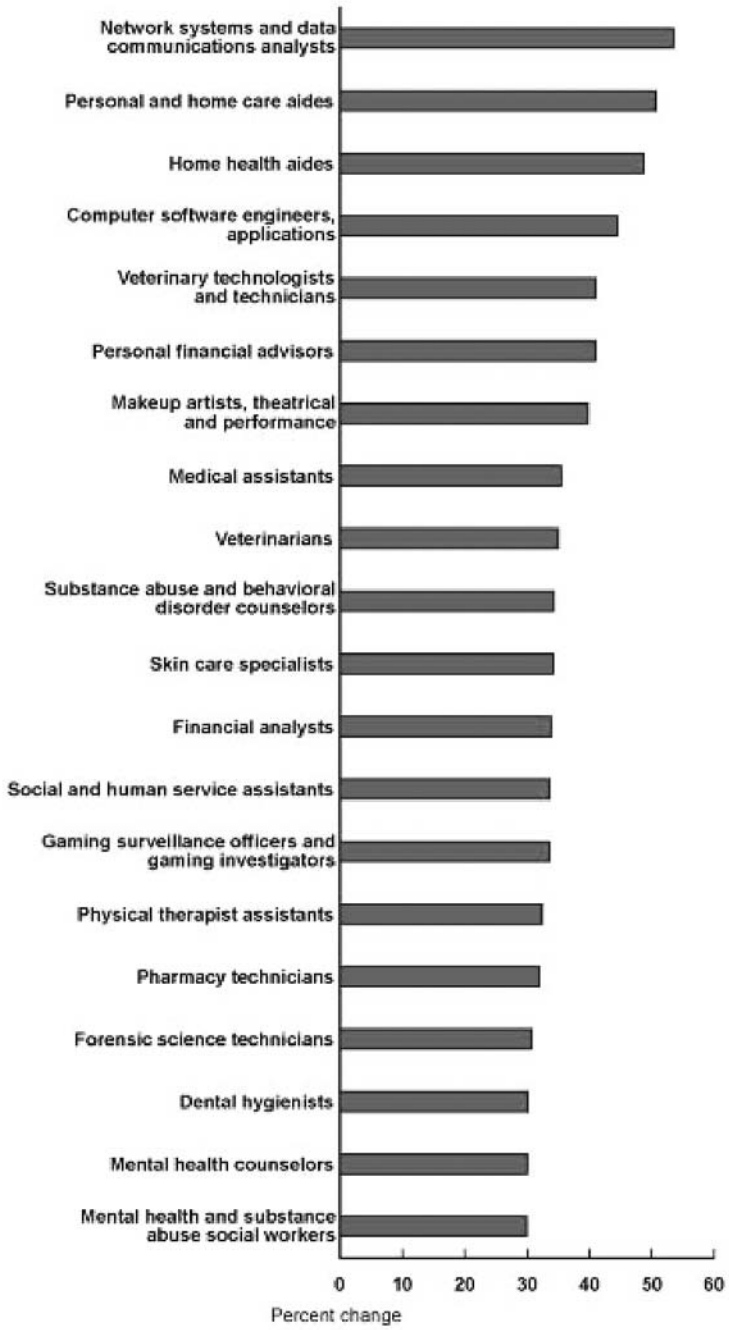
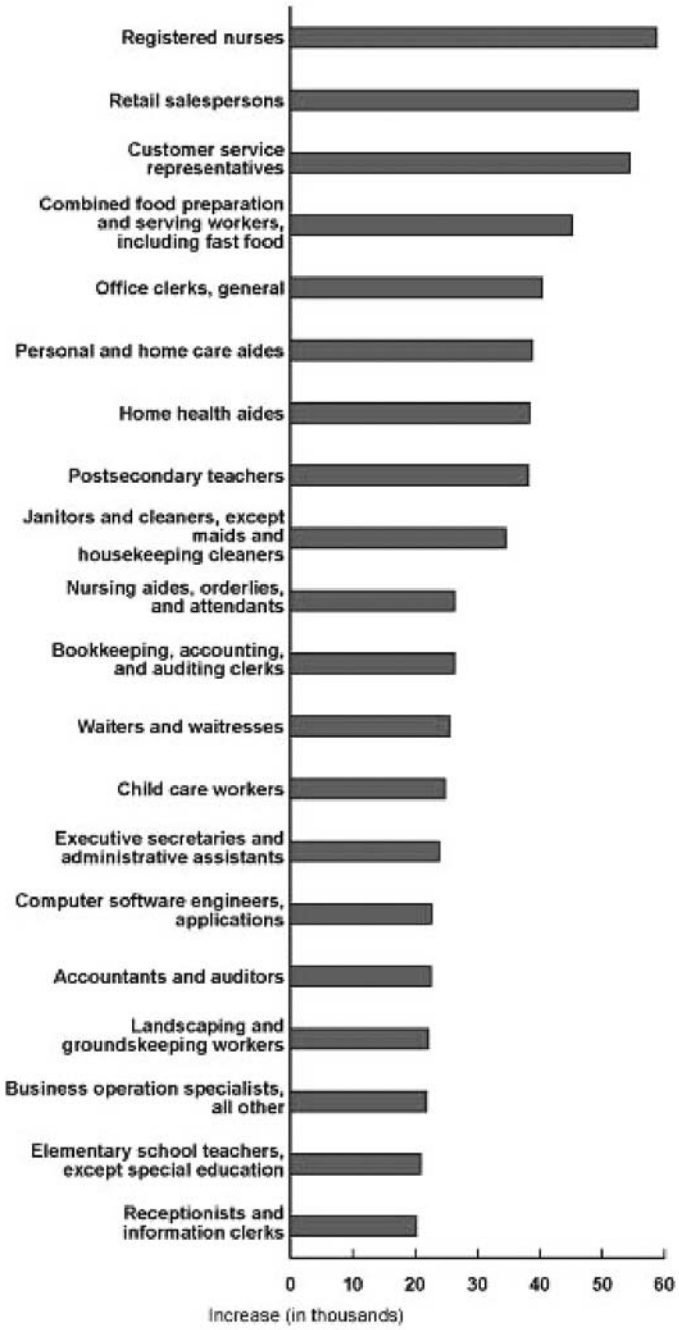


Chart 8. Occupations with the largest numerical increases in employment, projected 2006-2016



Career Research Sheet

Name: _____

Occupation	Cluster it belongs to	Average pay	Education and Training Needed to Achieve it

Information from the Occupational Outlook Handbook, by the Bureau of Labor Statistics